

Ἰππαρχος ὁ Νικαεύς

Hipparchus of Nicaea and the Commentary on Aratus

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Period: Ἑλληνιστική [Hellenistic](#)
Dialect: Κοινή τεχνική [Technical Koine](#)
Domain: Ἐπιστήμη [Science](#)
Format: Πραγματεία [Treatise](#)

Hipparchus of Nicaea was a Greek astronomer, geographer, and mathematician of the 2nd century BCE. He conducted his recorded astronomical observations, primarily from Rhodes, between 162 and 127 BCE. His work marks a decisive shift from speculative cosmology to a rigorous, mathematical, and observation-based science.

His original writings are almost entirely lost, known chiefly through later sources like Ptolemy's *Almagest*. One surviving work is his *Commentary on the Phaenomena of Aratus and Eudoxus*, which critiques the astronomical inaccuracies in those earlier texts. Lost contributions, known by reference, include the first comprehensive star catalog, studies on trigonometry, solar and lunar theory, and the discovery of the precession of the equinoxes.

Hipparchus established astronomy as a precise, predictive mathematical science. His trigonometric models and systematic observations set the standard for antiquity, making him a foundational figure upon whom Ptolemy heavily relied. He is often considered the true founder of systematic astronomy.

Works (2)

- Γεωγραφικά Ἀποσπάσματα · [Geographical Fragments](#) · 44 passages
- Περί τῶν Φαινομένων Ἀράτου καὶ Εὐδόξου · [On the Phenomena of Aratus and Eudoxus, Commentary Books III](#) · 368 passages